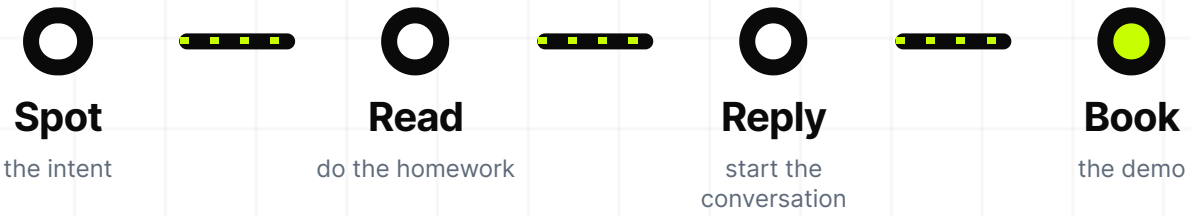
FREE PLAYBOOK · 2026

The Intent Playbook

The system that finds the people already asking, writes the first message and books the demo. For B2B service founders on LinkedIn.



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WHY MOST LINKEDIN OUTREACH STALLS

It's not a volume problem. It's a timing problem.

Most B2B service founders still run LinkedIn on a list. The buyers were never on the list. They were asking a question in a comment, two posts above yours.

THE USUAL WAY

- The founder posting at midnight
- Someone scraping a list of 1,000 names
- The same message to everyone
- Nobody following up

~~Scrape → Blast → Wait → Blame~~

Busy. Burnt out. Stuck at the same number.

THE INTENT WAY

- Start with people who already showed a reason
- Read their profile, company and post first
- A personal opener within hours, not days
- Follow-ups that add something every time

Spot → Read → Reply → Book

Fewer messages. Better timing. Real conversations.

What changes when you start from intent

Who

Only people who asked, reacted or changed something this week. Cold names never make the list.

When

Within hours of the signal, while the need is still fresh and before a competitor replies.

What

A first line about their signal, not about you. That's your permission to write.

01 · THE SYSTEM ON ONE PAGE

Spot → Read → Reply → Book

Four stages. Each one has a job, and none of them starts with a list.

SPOT

1

Spot the intent

Capture every question, like, follow, job change and funding round that matches your ideal customer. Cold names never make the list.

- Watch LinkedIn posts and comments for your topic
- Track competitor posts and the people who comment
- Log job changes, hiring and funding at target companies
- Check Reddit and X for people asking for recommendations

READ

2

Do the homework

Before anything goes out, read the profile, the company and the post they wrote. Three minutes, every time.

- Can this person buy, or influence the buy?
- Is the company the right size and type?
- What exactly did they say or do?
- One detail you'll mention in line one

REPLY

3

Start the conversation

A personal opener within hours. Follow-ups that sound like you, not like a sequence.

- Name the signal in the first line
- Give before you ask: an answer, an example
- Under 60 words, one question
- Up to 3 follow-ups, each adding something new

BOOK

4

Book the demo

Qualified people pick a time and it lands on the calendar. Unqualified people get a useful answer and a polite exit.

- Three quick qualifying questions
- Send the booking link only after a yes
- Confirm with a one-line agenda
- Log the meeting against the signal that started it

The 12 signals and what each means

The behaviours that show up again and again right before a company hires a service provider. Reply to the strongest first.

#	SIGNAL · WHAT IT MEANS	STRENGTH	REPLY WITHIN
01–04 · ENGAGING WITH THE PROBLEM			
01	**Asks a question about the problem you solve** They're stuck right now and looking for a way out.	Very high	Same day
02	**Likes three posts on the topic in one week** The topic is on their mind this week.	Medium	This week
03	**Comments on a competitor's post** They're comparing options.	Medium	This week
04	**Follows your profile** Something you posted landed.	Low	Anytime
05–08 · SOMETHING CHANGED ON THEIR SIDE			
05	**Views your profile twice** They're checking you out, on purpose.	Low	This week
06	**Changes job title** New budget, new mandate, about 90 days to show results.	Medium	Within 2 weeks
07	**Company starts hiring for the role you replace** They've decided the work needs doing.	High	This week
08	**Company raises a round** New money and pressure to grow fast.	Medium	Within 2 weeks
09–12 · ASKING OUT LOUD			
09	**Posts a "we're looking for" request** They're buying, and said so in public.	Very high	Same day
10	**Complains about a tool in your category** Unhappy with what they have: step one of switching.	High	1–2 days
11	**Reddit thread asking for recommendations** Researching options, often early and anonymous.	High	1–2 days
12	**X post tagging a competitor** Talking to or about a competitor in public.	Medium	1–2 days

03 · THE OPENER FOR EACH SIGNAL

12 signals, 12 openers

Congratulating a job change is not the same as answering a question. Swap the [brackets] for real details, or don't send it.

01 Asks a question about the problem you solve

Hi [name], saw your question about [problem]. What's worked for teams like yours: [one concrete answer]. Happy to share the [checklist] we use. Is it [A] or [B] that's slowing you down?

02 Likes three posts on the topic in one week

Hi [name], noticed you've been following the conversation about [topic] this week. We just put together [resource] on exactly that. Want me to send it over?

03 Comments on a competitor's post

Hi [name], saw your comment on [competitor]'s post. Fair point on [their point]. We see it from the other side: [one-line difference]. Looking at tools for this, or just following along?

04 Follows your profile

Thanks for the follow, [name]. Curious what brought you here: the posts on [topic], or something you're working on at [company]?

05 Views your profile twice

Hi [name], looks like our paths crossed on here. I help [type of company] with [outcome]. If [problem] is on your list, happy to share how others handle it.

06 Changes job title

Congrats on the new role at [company], [name]. The first months usually mean a fresh look at [area]. If [problem] is on the list, I can share what works for [similar teams].

07 Company starts hiring for the role you replace

Hi [name], saw [company] is hiring a [role]. While you search: we cover [that work] for teams like yours, starting this week. Worth comparing before you hire?

08 Company raises a round

Congrats on the [round], [name]. Usually the next step is scaling [area] fast. We help [type of company] do that without [common pain]. Part of the plan this quarter?

09 Posts a "we're looking for" request

Hi [name], saw you're looking for a [service]. That's what we do for [type of company], e.g. [example]. What's the timeline, and is [requirement] a must?

10 Complains about a tool in your category

Hi [name], saw your post about [tool] and [issue]. It's the most common reason teams move to us. Want a 2-minute look at how we handle it, no call needed?

11 Reddit thread asking for recommendations

[Answer the question properly in 3–5 sentences.] Disclosure: I build [product], which does [this], so I'm biased, but [honest one-line comparison].

12 X post tagging a competitor

[Answer or acknowledge in one line.] We built [product] for exactly this: [one-line difference]. Happy to show you if useful.

Signals 11 and 12 are public replies, on Reddit and X, not DMs. Answer first, disclose that it's your product, and never post a bare link.

04 · READ: THE 3-MINUTE HOMEWORK

Read before you write

Three minutes per person. It's what makes the first line sound like you were paying attention, because you were.

1 The person

- Role and seniority: can they buy, or influence the buy?
- How long in the role (new = open to change)
- What they post about, in their own words

2 The company

- Size and type: does it match your ideal customer?
- What they sell and to whom
- Recent news: hiring, funding, launches, a new market

3 The signal

- Exactly what they said or did, and when
- What they need, in their words, not yours
- How urgent it sounds: this week, this quarter, someday

4 The decision

- **Fit:** yes, maybe or no. "No" means skip, however tempting.
- **Hook:** the one detail you'll use in line one
- **Offer:** the one useful thing you can give first

Skip rule. If you can't fill the hook and the offer in under three minutes, the signal is too weak. Move to the next one.

Follow up like a person, not a sequence

Most replies come after a follow-up. Most follow-ups get ignored because they add nothing. Every message has to earn its place.

Day 0

The opener

Names the signal, gives something, asks one question.

Day 2–3

Follow-up 1: add something new

A resource, an example or a short answer to their question. Never "just bumping this".

> "Thought this might help with [problem]: [one-line tip or link]. No reply needed."

Day 6–7

Follow-up 2: a different angle

One easy question they can answer in five words.

> "Quick one: is [problem] a this-quarter thing or a next-year thing?"

Day 12–14

Follow-up 3: close the loop

Give them an easy way out. This one gets replies.

> "I'll stop here so I'm not cluttering your inbox. If [problem] comes back up, I'm one message away."

The rules

- Maximum **3 follow-ups**. Then stop.
- Each one **adds something new**. Never repeat the opener.
- **Stop at the first "no"**, and thank them.
- A yes gets **an answer within the hour**.
- Send in **their working hours**, on weekdays.
- A **new signal** from the same person restarts the clock.

06 · BOOK: THE DEMO

From reply to calendar

When someone replies with interest, qualify in one message, then book. The calendar link comes after the yes, never before.

THE QUALIFYING MESSAGE

Glad it's useful, [name]. Three quick ones so I don't waste your time: 1) what's the timeline for [problem], 2) roughly how big is the team or project, 3) who else would weigh in on a decision like this?

Qualified

Clear need, a timeline in the next 90 days, and they can decide or bring the person who does. Book the demo.

Not yet

A real need but no timeline. Send something useful and set a reminder for when they said it matters.

Not a fit

Wrong size, wrong service, or just curious. Give a helpful answer and a polite exit.

THE BOOKING MESSAGE

Sounds like a fit. Here's my calendar, pick any 20 minutes that works: [link]. I'll come with [the thing they asked about] ready, so it's useful even if you don't go ahead.

AFTER THEY BOOK

Thanks [name], see you [day]. Plan: 5 minutes on [their situation], 10 on how we'd handle [problem], 5 on next steps. Anything you'd like me to look at before then?

07 · THE WEEKLY REVIEW

30 minutes every Friday

Count what happened per signal. Keep the openers that get replies, rewrite the rest.

#	SIGNAL	SPOTTED	MESSAGED	REPLIED	BOOKED
01	Asks a question about the problem you solve				
02	Likes three posts on the topic in one week				
03	Comments on a competitor's post				
04	Follows your profile				
05	Views your profile twice				
06	Changes job title				
07	Company starts hiring for the role you replace				
08	Company raises a round				
09	Posts a "we're looking for" request				
10	Complains about a tool in your category				
11	Reddit thread asking for recommendations				
12	X post tagging a competitor				

Five questions

1. Which signal booked the most demos this week, and which booked none?
2. Which opener got the most replies? Copy what it did into the weakest one.
3. Where did good conversations stop: after the opener, a follow-up, or the qualifying message?
4. Did any "not a fit" share a pattern? Tighten the skip rule.
5. What's the one change you'll make next week? Just one.

KEEP THIS PAGE

The playbook on one page

SPOT

- 12 signals, strongest first
- Cold names never make the list
- Reply to "asking" signals the same day

READ

- Person, company, signal, decision
- Three minutes, then fit: yes, maybe, no
- No hook and no offer? Skip it

REPLY

- Name the signal in line one
- Give before you ask, under 60 words
- 3 follow-ups max, each adds something

BOOK

- Qualify in one message
- Calendar link only after a yes
- Confirm with a one-line agenda

~~Scrape → Blast → Wait → Blame~~

Spot → Read → Reply → Book

PS. The system doesn't take weekends off, and it reads comments more carefully than most of us do.

Intentsly.

RUN IT WITHOUT THE DAILY SCROLL

Intentsly runs this playbook for you

It spots the people asking, reads their profile and post, drafts the opener in your name and follows up. You review, send and take the demo.

1 Spot

2 Read

3 Reply

4 Book

See it on your own website intentsly.com/try-ai →

No signup needed.

